

Weekly Economic Commentary 20 Jul 2026

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 By [Westpac New Zealand Economics](#)

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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Soggy activity data ahead of key CPI report

Following this month’s RBNZ meeting, which resulted in the first OCR hike in three years, the market has turned its attention to the prospect of a follow-up rate hike at the next meeting on 2 September. The past week has provided numerous economic reports and a key RBNZ speech for the market to digest, covering topics such as business sentiment, consumer spending, housing, the labour market, tourism and inflation.

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